SUMMARY

Former research engineer turned writer, organizer, and community builder, with experience in civic leadership, grassroots advocacy, and the literary arts. Combines analytical problem-solving with creative practice to strengthen local communities, support meaningful change, and foster human connection.

CONTACT

Lexington, KY
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(563) 316-4818
www.carinagrady.com

EDUCATION

IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY
B.S. Mechanical Engineering
Cum Laude | May 2019

LITERARY PUBLICATIONS

"The Violinist's Ballad." Poem. *Yearling*, Vol. 5, forthcoming 2026.

"Rebel Until It Becomes Another Latte Flavor." Poem. *All the Broods are Hatching at Once*, Lexington Poetry Month, 2025.

"The Serpent's Utopia." Short story. *Blah, Blah, Blah Anthology, Volume Three: Crossroads*, 2025.

WRITING INTERESTS

Genres: spoken/written poetry, hybrid/experimental writing, literary fiction, satirical performance skits

Themes: resistance, social critique, digital technologies, capitalism, alienation, intersectionality, self-confrontation

CARINA GRADY

LITERARY EXPERIENCE

ACCENTS PUBLISHING, *Intern*

Kentucky-based independent press publishing poetry.
Lexington, KY | February 2026 – Present

- Produced poetry videos, promotional materials, and merchandise supporting publications, authors, and marketing.
- Advised on website development and digital outreach strategies to strengthen audience engagement and expand visibility.
- Completed a five-month Poetry Bootcamp focused on developing, revising, arranging, and preparing a poetry manuscript for publication.

LEVEE ART COLLECTIVE, *Manager*

Grassroots activist space for marginalized creatives and organizers.
Lexington, KY | June 2025 – Present

- Managed community space operations and coordinated large-scale fundraisers, cultural events, and community gatherings.
- Facilitated the Q-BIPOC Writing Group for racialized and queer writers, cultivating a supportive space for creative expression.
- Organized and taught monthly Latin dance lessons and socials.

CARNEGIE CENTER, *Student & Volunteer*

Non-profit literacy center offering education and community literacy initiatives.
Lexington, KY | June 2025 – Present

- Completed poetry and fiction classes, including the yearlong Poetry Gauntlet, focusing on craft, workshop, and consistency.
- Supported community writing groups, literary events, readings, and conferences through active participation and volunteer involvement.
- Founded and led Young Poets Society, facilitating recurring writing sessions and discussions centered on Gen Z themes.

FRIENDS BOOK CELLAR, *Volunteer*

Non-profit used bookstore supporting the Lexington Public Libraries.
Lexington, KY | March 2026 – Present

- Assisted customers and operated the register while evaluating, pricing, and organizing donated books for resale.
- Provided recommendations on social media and promotional content to strengthen visibility and engagement.

YOUNG WRITERS SOCIETY, *Staff*

International writing community connecting writers across genres.
Remote | October 2019 – July 2022

- Moderated discussions, supported members, resolved conflicts, and upheld standards across an international writing network.
- Encouraged participation through writing activities, workshops, critiques, and guidance on craft development.

SCHOLARSHIP

Awarded 2015–2019:

- Multicultural Vision Scholar, Iowa State University
- National Buick Achievers Scholar
- Iowa Rotary Club Scholar
- Community Foundation of the Great River Bend Scholarships

PERFORMANCES

Featured Poet:

- Queerapalooza. Frankfurt, KY, June 2026.
- Plural Connection Summer Solstice Festival, Lexington, KY, June 2026.
- Live Poets' Society. Lexington, KY, November 2026.

EXHIBITS

They tell me that writing is a form of art founded on rules, Living Art Exhibit: Visual Poetry, Levee Collective, Lexington, KY, May 2026.

READINGS

Open Mics in Lexington, KY:

Poetry at the Table
Bespoke Karmic Experience
Multifarious Collective
Soulbrations

MEMBERSHIPS

Lexington Writer's Room
Kentucky State Poetry Society
Levee Art Collective
Fayette County Climate Action

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

First Author: Grady, C., et al. "Design Tool for Estimating Adsorbent Hydrogen Storage System Characteristics for Light-Duty Fuel Cell Vehicles." International Journal of Hydrogen Energy 47 (2022): 29847–29857.

CIVIC EXPERIENCE

LIVING STREETS LEXINGTON, *Member*

Grassroots group transforming streets into vibrant, safe, accessible spaces.
Lexington, KY | April 2025 – September 2026

- Advocated for safer, more inclusive transportation by canvassing, engaging city council members, and supporting biking, walking, and public transit initiatives like the Week Without Driving campaign.
- Assisted in organizing Lexington's first street-art mural, designed by a local artist to slow neighborhood traffic while bringing color and cultural vibrancy to the surrounding streetscape.

ENVIRONMENTAL COMMISSION, *Chair*

Municipal commission advancing sustainability and climate resilience.
Lexington, KY | March 2025 – November 2025

- Chaired commission meetings, guided committee work, and represented the commission in city government discussions on environmental, sustainability, and community priorities.
- Led initiatives on public solar installations, low-income energy-efficiency incentives, sustainability ordinances, and pollinator gardens supporting resilience and biodiversity.

ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

GUIDEHOUSE, *Senior Consultant*

Utility clients in the Energy, Sustainability, & Infrastructure segment.
Remote | August 2022 – August 2025

- Led project management and evaluation of utility energy-efficiency initiatives, overseeing delivery, budgets, client needs, and compliance with residential and industry standards.
- Analyzed large energy and survey datasets, including heat-pump performance, consumption trends, and retail pricing, to develop recommendations and predictive models for research and planning.

SAVANNAH RIVER NATIONAL LABORATORY, *Engineer*

R&D Institution by Battelle Savannah River Alliance.
Aiken, SC | July 2019 – July 2022

- Simulated nuclear material logistics to optimize drum movement, scheduling, and facility operations, identifying opportunities for significant time and cost savings for government.
- Modeled hydrogen fuel-cell systems for light-duty vehicles and onboard storage, contributing to published research and hands-on work in batteries, additive manufacturing, and nanomaterials.

PACIFIC GAS & ELECTRIC, *Intern*

Diablo Canyon Nuclear Power Plant of 2200 MW capacity.
Avila Beach, CA | June – Aug 2018

- Reduced maintenance costs by resolving eight maintenance issues and presenting preventive-maintenance recommendations.